BEE IT

ICP & Buyer Personas

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Overview

This document defines the Bee IT updated Ideal Customer Profile (ICP) system, structured across two acquisition tracks and three tiers each. It is designed to build a structured approach for both direct client acquisition and agency/whitelabel partnerships.

Each tier includes firmographic filters, buyer persona profiles, pain points, goals, buying triggers, and the content/proof points needed to convert each persona.

TRACK A: Direct Clients

- Brands and companies that hire Bee IT directly, without an intermediary agency.
- Higher margin, longer relationships, and the preferred growth path.
- This track is the primary focus for new business development.

Tier 1: Dream Clients

TARGET TITLES:

Chief Digital Officer (CDO)

Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

VP of Digital/VP of eCommerce

VP of Engineering

Chief Information Officer (CIO)

Chief Revenue Officer (CRO)

Chief Transformation Officer

SVP/VP of Product

COMMERCIAL PROFILE TARGET

Deal Size: €20,000 - €350,000+
Sales Cycle: 4 to 10 months
Win Frequency: Low frequency, very high value
Company Revenue: €100M+
Employees: 250+
Geography: Benelux, DACH Region, UK, USA
Platforms: Salesforce Commerce Cloud, Magento Enterprise
Industries: Fashion & Luxury, Consumer Electronics, Retail Chains

PROSPECTING SIGNALS

- Running Salesforce Commerce Cloud or Magento Enterprise
- An active digital transformation initiative is underway or announced (scoops, signals, etc.)
- Recent C-suite hire: CTO, CDO, or Chief Revenue Officer
- Received Series B+ funding (solid signal can also be a VC/PE investment)
- Scaling into new international markets

Persona Profile: VP of Digital / Chief Digital Officer

Industry: Fashion & Luxury
Geography: Belgium
"*I need a partner who gets both the tech and the brand.*
Most agencies only understand one."
"A partner who would work with me on enhancing my distribution efficiency."

GOALS

- Lead global digital transformation across all channels
- Own the full omnichannel customer experience
- Hit aggressive board-level revenue targets from eCommerce

PAIN POINTS

- Cannot find agencies that understand luxury UX and enterprise tech simultaneously
- Internal dev team is too slow to handle seasonal demand spikes
- Board pressure to grow digital revenue as a share of total revenue

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BUYING TRIGGERS

- New CDO mandate from the board
- Platform migration from Magento 1 (end-of-life pressure)
- US market expansion (or vice versa for US brands going EU/UK) requiring a scalable digital foundation

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- ROI-focused case studies from comparable luxury or fashion brands
- Visible Salesforce Commerce Cloud certifications
- References from existing Tier 1 enterprise clients
- Our capability to clearly show how deeply we understand how to grow their business

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Persona Profile: CTO / Chief Innovation Officer

Industry: Consumer Electronics
Geography: USA
"Show me the code quality and the process. I'll figure out the rest."

GOALS

- Build a scalable eCommerce infrastructure for global product launches
- Reduce time-to-market for new product lines
- Own technology stack decisions end-to-end

PAIN POINTS

- Hiring senior SFCC or Magento developers in-house is prohibitively expensive and slow
- US, UK, EU agencies can charge 3 to 4x the rate of comparable Eastern European talent without compromising development quality
- Needs the flexibility to scale development teams up and down with product cycles

BUYING TRIGGERS

- Potential IPO preparation or a new fundraising round that benefits from a tech infrastructure upgrade
- New product line launch with aggressive go-live deadline
- The current vendor is underperforming, or the relationship is breaking down

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- Technical deep-dive sessions and architecture proposals
- Clear cost comparison - example: US agency rates vs Bee IT rates for equivalent quality
- Low-risk pilot project offer before committing to full engagement

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Tier 2: Sweet Spot - PRIMARY focus

Bee IT's highest-priority tier for potential direct client acquisition.

The deal sizes are achievable, the sales cycle is short enough to build pipeline velocity, and the buyer profile aligns perfectly with Bee IT's existing portfolio and expertise.

TARGET TITLES:

Head of eCommerce

Head of Digital

Head of Sales/Distribution

Head of Product

Head of R&D

Senior Director/Director of Digital Experience

SVP/VP of Technology

SVP/VP Engineering

IT Director/Head of IT

Director of Digital Marketing

COMMERCIAL PROFILE TARGET

Deal Size: €20,000 - €150,000+
Sales Cycle: 6 - 10 weeks
Win Frequency: Medium frequency, high value
Company Revenue: €20M - €100M
Employees: 50 - 500
Geography: Benelux, DACH Region, UK, USA
Platforms: Magento 2, SFCC, Shopify Plus (migration target)
Industries: Retail, Fashion & Apparel, Health & Beauty, Pharmacy, FMCG

PROSPECTING SIGNALS

- Still running Magento 1 (end-of-life creates urgency)
- Head of eCommerce or similar role hired in the last 12 months
- Seasonal traffic spikes are causing performance or stability issues
- Transactional bottlenecks
- Running significant paid advertising, but conversion rates are low
- A competitor has recently launched a visibly improved digital experience

Persona Profile: Head of eCommerce / Digital Commerce Director

Industry: Retail / Fashion
Geography: UK
"I don't need the cheapest agency. I need a one I can actually rely on."
“One who will think instead of me because I haven't earned enough in-house expertise yet.”

GOALS

- Ship features and updates faster without breaking production
- Successfully migrate off a legacy platform (Magento 1 → 2 or SFCC)
- Scale development capacity without committing to full-time hires

PAIN POINTS

- Agencies that disappear after kickoff and deliver outside of the defined timeline
- Developers who require constant business context hand-holding
- Inflexible contracts that cannot adapt to changing scope
- Poor communication across time zones is causing delays
- Smaller agencies provide more fractured services to smaller clients, so the clients have to hire 2 or more partners for a complex task. Cheaper 360 is our key.

BUYING TRIGGERS

- Platform end-of-life deadline creating urgency
- Black Friday or peak season performance failure
- The competitor is launching a significantly better user experience

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- Case studies featuring brands of similar size and industry
- Clutch reviews, Book of Business, Website Portfolio visibility, and verifiable client references
- Free consultation (or with a defined and capped price that becomes a part of the potential contract price deduction) with a concrete 30-day roadmap proposal. Short and visible first step with very trackable results.

Persona 2: Head of Digital / eCommerce Manager

Industry: Health & Beauty / Pharmacy
Geography: Belgium
"We are not a tech company, but we need to start thinking like one."

GOALS

- Launch or replatform the company's webshop on a modern, scalable stack
- Integrate loyalty programmes and CRM into the digital experience
- Drive repeat purchase behaviour and increase online revenue share

PAIN POINTS

- Internal IT department does not understand the e-commerce requirements
- Local agencies lack SFCC or Magento expertise
- Regulatory and compliance requirements slow every project down

BUYING TRIGGERS

- Leadership mandate to digitalize the pharmacy or beauty retail channel
- New investor pushing for online revenue growth targets
- Competitor launches an app or improved digital storefront

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- The Lilly (Serbia) or similar case study, as local credibility is a powerful hook for this segment
- Demonstrated GDPR and compliance track record (the closer to personal health details, involved, the more it matters)
- Phased project approach that reduces perceived risk

Tier 3: Entry & Emerging

TARGET TITLES:

CEO/Founder

Co-Founder

Managing Director

Head of Sales (owner-led brands where sales = revenue = digital)

Marketing Manager

IT Manager

Operations Manager

General Manager

COMMERCIAL PROFILE TARGET

Deal Size: €15,000 - €40,000
Sales Cycle: 3 - 6 weeks
Win Frequency: Higher frequency, lower value, good for pipeline volume and referrals
Company Revenue: €2M - €20M
Employees: 10 - 100
Geography: Central & Eastern Europe + Smaller EU brands
Platforms: Magento 2, WooCommerce (WordPress) to Magento migration, Custom PHP
Industries: Niche Retail, Local Fashion, SMB eCommerce, Lifestyle, Health

PROSPECTING SIGNALS

- No dedicated development team; all tech is outsourced or neglected
- CEO or founder is also the digital decision-maker
- Running on an outdated or custom-built platform
- Wants to compete with larger regional or national players
- Referred directly by an existing Bee IT client or internal personal network

Persona Profile: CEO / Founder (Owner-operated brand)

Industry: Niche Retail / Local Brand
Geography: Slovenia
"I just want it to work, and I want to trust the people building it."
“The money we're discussing are my one and only limit which I'm spending once, so I'm not ready for risks.”

GOALS

- Build a professional webshop that converts visitors into buyers
- Reduce dependency on marketplaces and go direct-to-consumer
- Compete effectively with larger regional players online

PAIN POINTS

- A previous agency built something that broke or failed to deliver
- No internal budget for a full development team
- Does not know which platform to choose or how to evaluate vendors

BUYING TRIGGERS

- Marketplace fees are eating into margins and pushing the business to own its channel
- A trusted word-of-mouth referral from another founder
- Approaching the seasonal sales period with an urgent deadline

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- Communication in local language; relationship-first approach
- Local success story as social proof
- Fixed-price engagement with a milestone-based payment schedule

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TRACK B: Agency & Whitelabel Partners

Agencies, system integrators, and consultancies that subcontract Bee IT for development work.

This is Bee IT's proven, existing revenue engine and remains a core growth pillar.

Agency relationships often deliver high-volume, recurring work with lower acquisition cost than direct clients.

Tier 1: Strategic Agency Partners

TARGET TITLES:

SVP/VP of Delivery/Director of Delivery

CEO Managing Director

Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

VP of Engineering

Head of Client Services

Engagement Director

Practice Lead (Commerce / Salesforce)

Solutions Architect

COMMERCIAL PROFILE TARGET

Deal Size: €20,000 - €350,000+
Sales Cycle: 4 - 8 months (relationship-driven)
Win Frequency: Low frequency, very high volume of sub-contracted work
Agency Revenue: €10M+ annual revenue

Agency Size: 50 - 300 staff
Geography: Benelux, DACH Region, UK, USA
Platforms: SFCC, Magento Enterprise, API First/ Modular commerce
Type: Full-service digital agencies, System Integrators, Salesforce partners

PROSPECTING SIGNALS

- Salesforce or Adobe partner that needs to scale SFCC or Magento dev capacity
- Availability of an enterprise retainer, but lacking the certified technical depth
- Expanding its geographic footprint from the USA to Europe or vice versa
- Recently lost a senior developer or had a team reduction
- Listed and active on the Salesforce AppExchange

Persona 1: VP of Delivery / Engagement Director

Industry: Full-service Digital Agency
Geography: USA
"I need a partner I can trust blindly on technical delivery. That's rare."

GOALS

- Deliver client projects on time and on budget without burning the internal team
- Access certified SFCC and Magento talent fast, without a long recruitment process
- White-label development at its finest, the client is managed by the agency

PAIN POINTS

- Cannot find reliable nearshore or offshore partners that match the agency quality bar
- Previous partners missed deadlines and damaged client relationships
- Timezone gaps cause review and approval delays that compound into larger problems

BUYING TRIGGERS

- Winning a new enterprise client requiring SFCC development
- Internal development team overloaded with concurrent projects
- Existing nearshore or offshore partner failed before on a key delivery

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- NDA and white-label capability demonstrated upfront
- Sample code and technical audit demonstrating quality standards
- Discovery call with Bee IT's delivery to establish technical credibility (once it’s fullfils at least BANT qualification)

Persona 2: CEO / Managing Director (Boutique SFCC Agency)

Industry: Salesforce Commerce Cloud System Integrator
Geography: Germany
"If you can deliver SFCC at a competitive rate with real certifications, we should talk."

GOALS

- Win larger SFCC enterprise deals by adding flexible dev capacity
- Improve project margins by leveraging outsourcing talent
- Build a long-term, trusted sub-contractor relationship with consistent quality

PAIN POINTS

- Western European agencies charge rates that make enterprise projects uncompetitive
- Hard to find SFCC-certified developers in Western Europe
- Clients increasingly compare agency-built solutions to best-in-class alternatives

BUYING TRIGGERS

- New SFCC project in the pipeline that exceeds current team capacity
- Expansion into new industry verticals requiring fresh expertise
- Existing sub-contractor raises rates or underperforms

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- Shared list of Bee IT SFCC certifications and case studies
- High-level rates (indicative) showing a clear cost advantage vs Western European alternatives
- A reference from another EU-based agency already using Bee IT

Tier 2: Growth Agency Partners

TARGET TITLES:

CEO / Founder (boutique agency)

Head of Delivery

Project Director

Technical Lead / Lead Developer

Head of eCommerce Practice

Account Director

Head of Partnerships

Operations Director

COMMERCIAL PROFILE TARGET

Deal Size: €20,000 - €80,000+ per project
Sales Cycle: 4 - 8 weeks
Win Frequency: Medium frequency, steady ongoing work
Agency Revenue: €2M - €10M
Agency Size: 15 - 80 staff
Geography: Benelux, DACH Region, UK, USA
Platforms: Magento 2, SFCC, Shopify Plus
Type: Mid-size digital agencies, eCommerce consultancies, UX-led agencies

PROSPECTING SIGNALS

- Active on Clutch with eCommerce clients listed in portfolio
- Posts about Magento or SFCC on LinkedIn or other media outlets regularly
- Currently hiring for senior developer roles, a clear signal of capacity problems (signals on Y-hire, HacNews, Slack communities)
- Client base overlaps with the Fashion, Retail, or FMCG sectors
- Has strong design or strategy capability, but a limited deep development bench

Persona: Founder / CEO (Boutique eCommerce Agency)

Industry: eCommerce Consultancy
Geography: Netherlands
I have been burned by offshore before. Show me you are different in the first two weeks."

GOALS

- Scale project delivery without growing full-time headcount
- Take on Magento Enterprise clients that are currently out of reach
- Improve delivery margins on the existing project portfolio

PAIN POINTS

- A small team gets overwhelmed when multiple large projects run concurrently
- Cannot find reliable Magento developers locally at competitive rates
- Clients are pushing for faster delivery windows than the team can support

BUYING TRIGGERS

- New client wins a project requiring Magento Enterprise scope
- Current sub-contractor raises rates or fails a delivery
- Bee IT was introduced via an industry contact or mutual connection

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- Demonstrated portfolio overlap, Bee IT has built similar things for similar clients
- Flexible engagement model: T&M or fixed price, depending on the project
- A low-stakes pilot project to prove quality within two weeks

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Tier 3: Opportunistic Partners

TARGET TITLES:

Independent eCommerce Consultant

Agency Owner

Head of Technology

Web Development Lead

Digital Consultant

Project Manager

Technical Project Manager

COMMERCIAL PROFILE TARGET

Deal Size: €5,000 - €20,000
Sales Cycle: 4-10 weeks
Win Frequency: Higher frequency, smaller engagements
Agency Revenue: Under €2M
Agency Size: 1 - 15 people
Geography: Central & Eastern Europe + Global freelancer networks
Platforms: Magento 2, WooCommerce, Custom
Type: Small local agencies, IT consultancies, Freelance Enterpreneurs

PROSPECTING SIGNALS

- Small local agency that has won a project above their technical level
- Referred through the Bee IT professional network or alumni
- Active in local IT communities, meetups, or startup events
- Freelancer with more incoming work than personal capacity

Persona: eCommerce Consultant / Small Agency Owner

Industry: Freelance Entrepreneur / Micro-agency
Geography: Austria
"*I just need someone good who will not steal my client."*

GOALS

- Sub-contract development work to deliver client projects that they cannot handle alone
- Access to Magento expertise that they don't have in-house
- Grow the practice into a proper agency over time

PAIN POINTS

- No reliable development partner for projects above their own capacity
- Loses potential clients because they can't scale to meet their needs on their own.
- Struggles to compete with larger agencies on enterprise or mid-market briefs

BUYING TRIGGERS

- A client project arrives that is too large to handle independently
- Bee IT was mentioned at a local tech event or in a community group
- Introduction via a LinkedIn connection or mutual contact

WHAT MAKES PERSONA SAY YES

- Relationship-first approach with transparent, honest communication
- Flexible terms for smaller, short-duration projects
- Clear assurance that Bee IT operates as a silent partner and respects client ownership

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Quick Reference Summary

The table below summarises all six tiers across both tracks for fast reference during prospecting and qualification calls.

DIRECT CLIENT TRACK

Tier 1: Dream Clients

- Chief Digital Officer (CDO)
- Chief Technology Officer (CTO)
- VP of Digital/VP of eCommerce
- VP of Engineering
- Chief Information Officer (CIO)
- Chief Revenue Officer (CRO)
- Chief Transformation Officer,
- SVP/VP of Product

Tier 2: Sweet Spot

- Head of eCommerce
- Head of Digital
- Head of Product
- Head of R&D
- Senior Director/Director of Digital Experience
- SVP/VP of Technology
- SVP/VP Engineering
- IT Director/Head of IT
- Director of Digital Marketing

Tier 3: Entry & Emerging

- CEO/Founder
- Co-Founder
- Managing Director
- Head of Sales (owner-led brands where sales = revenue = digital)
- Marketing Manager
- IT Manager
- Operations Manager
- General Manager

AGENCY / WHITELABEL TRACK

Tier 1: Strategic Partners

- SVP/VP of Delivery/Director of Delivery
- CEO Managing Director
- Chief Technology Officer (CTO)
- VP of Engineering
- Head of Client Services

- Engagement Director
- Practice Lead (Commerce / Salesforce)
- Solutions Architect

Tier 2: Growth Partners

- CEO / Founder (boutique agency)
- Head of Delivery
- Project Director
- Technical Lead / Lead Developer
- Head of eCommerce Practice
- Account Director
- Head of Partnerships
- Operations Director

Tier 3: Opportunistic

- Independent eCommerce Consultant
- Agency Owner
- Head of Technology
- Web Development Lead
- Digital Consultant
- Project Manager
- Technical Project Manager